

BRAND GUIDE

JULY 2026

YOUR AUDIENCE SHOULD BELONG TO YOU.

FOR ARTISTS & THEIR PEOPLE

OVERVIEW

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SECTION 01

The Brand

Mission & Vision

Brand Promise & Guardrails

Personality

Who We Serve

01

SECTION 01 · THE BRAND

Mission & Vision

MISSION

Give independent artists a music-native space they own, where the relationship with fans belongs to the artist and scattered listeners become a community that funds a sustainable career.

VISION

A world where artists no longer rent access to their own fans.

Artist-First Ownership

The artist owns the audience, the data, and the exit. Fan lists are exportable, always.

Community-Driven

Built with working musicians, for working musicians. Decisions start from what artists actually need.

Transparency & Trust

Plain language, honest pricing, no dark patterns. Trust is the product.

SECTION 01 · THE BRAND

Brand Promise & Guardrails

THE PROMISE

ZuZu turns your most dedicated listeners into a fan community you own: direct access, recurring support, and data that leaves with you.

GUARDRAILS

01	Never compromise artist ownership of exportable fan data.
02	No tech-bro buzzwords, no manufactured urgency. Clarity over flash, buzz, and hype.
03	Never lead with price. Lead with access and recognition.
04	Optimize every decision for trust, clarity, and joy.

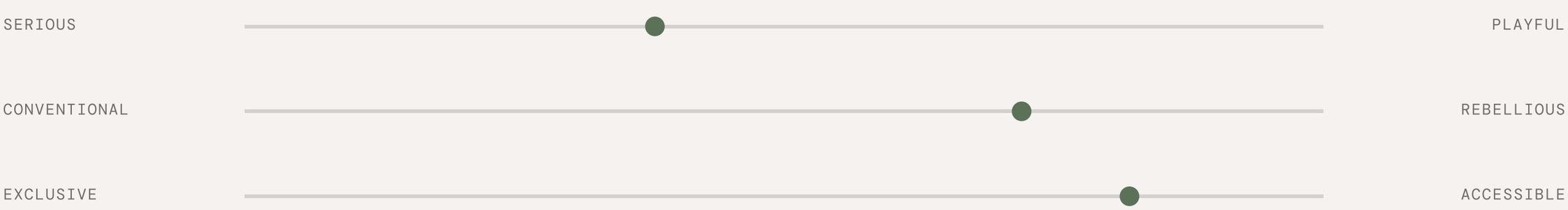
SECTION 01 · THE BRAND

Personality

ZuZu speaks like a trusted teammate: someone in the artist's corner who has done the work and shares the ambition.

- **Authentic**
  We say the true thing, plainly.
- **Optimistic**
  The independent path is winnable.
- **Creative**
  Music-native in look, language, and instinct.
- **Transparent**
  How it works and what it costs, always visible.

SPECTRUMS



SECTION 01 · THE BRAND

Who We Serve

ARTISTS

Independent musicians who want a direct line to the people who care, and recurring support without becoming a full-time community manager.

01 A broadcast line they own, not rent

02 Audience data that is exportable, always

03 Support that compounds quietly, $1 at a time

FANS

The people who show up first. They want closeness, first access, and quiet recognition: to witness the process, and a place to belong.

01 A direct line, and closeness that lands first

02 First access: music and drops before anyone

03 A place to belong, with the process opened

THE VALUE HIERARCHY: WHAT WE LEAD WITH, IN ORDER

01	The direct line to the artist	closeness that lands with you first
02	First access	music and drops before anyone
03	Belonging	the artist's world, then your people in it
04	The process, opened	demos, diaries, the Vault
05	A hand in what's next	votes that count
06	Quiet recognition	private by default, shown by choice

The music is the medium, not a perk: every promise above attaches to a song. Price is always demoted: a quiet "$1 a month · cancel anytime" beneath the action, never in a headline, never in a CTA.

SECTION 02

Voice & Language

Voice Foundations
Vocabulary
Voice by Channel
Microcopy Patterns

02

SECTION 02 · VOICE & LANGUAGE

Voice Foundations

Authentic, passionate, and a little rebellious. We say the true thing plainly, side with artists, and never talk like a platform.

Clarity beats cleverness

If a fan has to re-read it, rewrite it. Plain words, short sentences, zero jargon.

Warm, never corporate

Write like a bandmate, not a brand. Contractions welcome. Buzzwords are banned.

Confident, never hype

No exclamation-mark enthusiasm, no growth-speak. Let access and proof do the talking.

The artist’s name goes first

Every surface promotes the artist, not ZuZu. We stay backstage.

Tone leans serious, because we’re handling someone’s livelihood, but never solemn. Think liner notes, not legal notes.

SECTION 02 · VOICE & LANGUAGE

Vocabulary

SAY THIS	NEVER THIS
Fan Community	inner circle · club · tier
your people · Founding Fans	members · subscribers · VIPs
Join Rand	subscribe · unlock · sign up for premium
supporting an artist	monetize your fans · paywall
“$1 a month · cancel anytime”, kept quiet beneath the button	price in the headline or CTA

“Inner circle”, “subscription”, “VIP” and “members” are retired everywhere a fan or artist can read. They repel both sides; the research was unambiguous.

Still fine: Fan · Superfan · community building (internal strategy docs only).

SECTION 02 · VOICE & LANGUAGE

Voice by Channel

PRODUCT UI	Calm, exact, zero hype. Buttons say what they do. Nothing shouts.
PUSH	Rare and personal. Reads like it came from the artist, not the app.
SOCIAL	Scene-native and playful. We post like a band, not a brand.
ARTIST OUTREACH	Peer to peer, specific, short. Show we've listened before we pitch.
SUPPORT	Human and accountable. Fast to own mistakes, faster to fix them.

SECTION 02 · VOICE & LANGUAGE

Microcopy Patterns

JOIN CTA

Join Rand

$1 a month · cancel anytime

WELCOME

You’re in. Rand knows you’re here early.

Recognition before instruction.

EMPTY FEED

Nothing yet. Rand’s in the studio.

You’ll be the first to know.

ERROR

That didn’t save. Try again. We kept your draft.

Own it, fix it, keep their work.

HOW WE WRITE

Talk to one fan at a time. · Keep the price small and quiet. · Make people feel seen, not sold to. · If the artist wouldn’t say it, neither do we.

SECTION 03

Logo

The Mark & Lockups

Clear Space & Minimum Sizes

Logo Don’ts

SECTION 03 · LOGO

The Mark & Lockups

PRIMARY LOCKUP



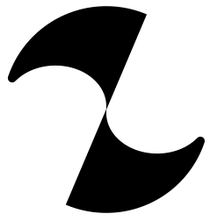
Mark left at cap height, wordmark right. The default for every horizontal use.

STACKED



Mark above wordmark, for square and vertical spaces. The mark still leads.

MONOGRAM



The mark alone: app icon, favicon, tight UI. Never beside the full logo.

CONSTRUCTION RULES

The mark leads. Always.

Wordmark: DM Mono Medium, −5% tracking. Horizontal: the mark stands 1.3× the Z cap height, optically centered on the cap band, with a gap of 0.36× cap. Stacked: the mark is twice the cap height, centered above. Never place the mark after the wordmark.

How every configuration is built, and the one order that never changes.

Configurations are fixed artwork: use the supplied files, never rebuild. On dark surfaces use the reversed light versions. The mark always leads.

SECTION 03 · LOGO

Clear Space & Minimum Sizes



X = 30% of the Z emblem’s height. Keep this border clear of typography, UI, and competing graphics, on every side, at every size.

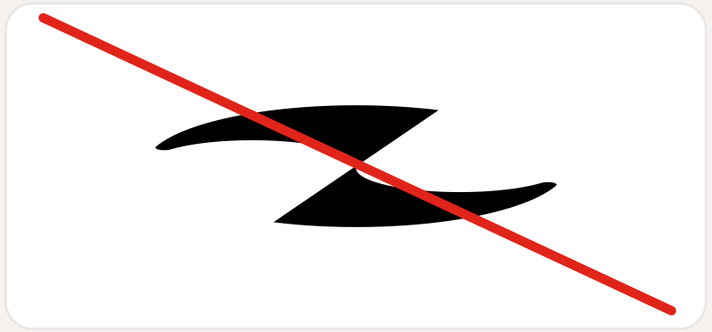
MINIMUM SIZES

Lockups, digital	24 px height
Lockups, print	0.375 in / 9.5 mm
Monogram, digital	16 × 16 px
Monogram, print	0.25 in / 6.3 mm

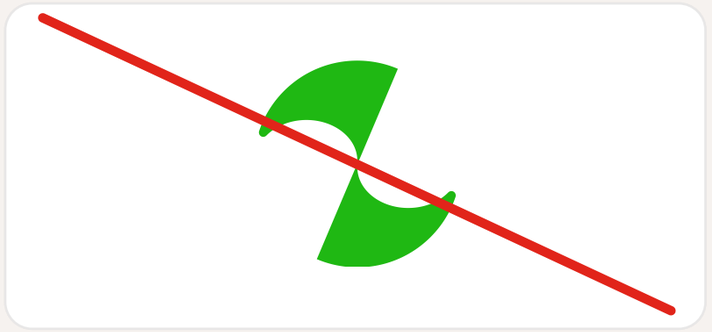
Below minimum, drop to the next smaller configuration. Never letterbox or squeeze.

SECTION 03 · LOGO

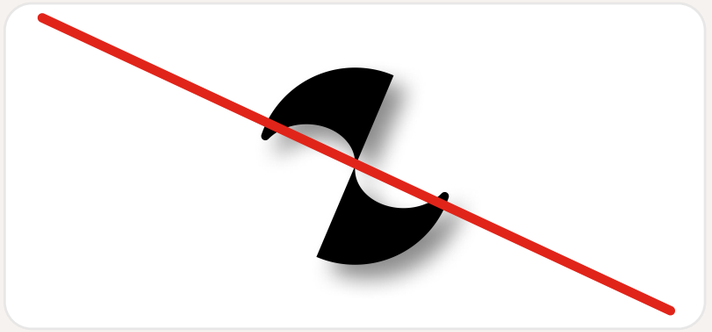
Logo Don’ts



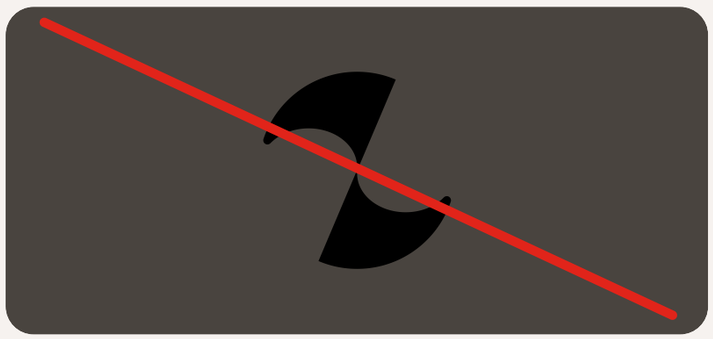
Don’t stretch or skew



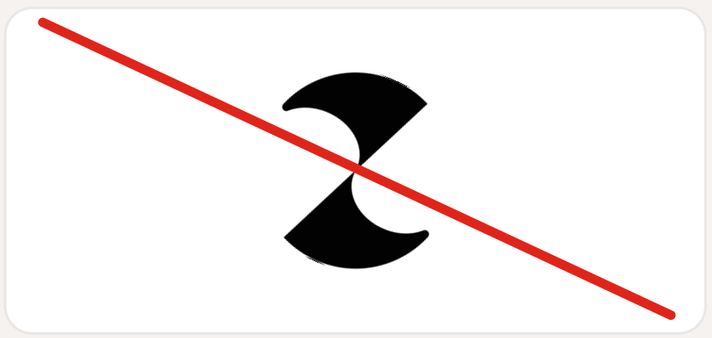
Don’t recolor outside the palette



Don’t add shadows or glows



Don’t place on low contrast



Don’t rotate or redraw the mark



Don’t crowd the clear space

These rules apply to every configuration, at every size, on every surface.

SECTION 03 · LOGO

App Icon

THE MASTER · 1024 × 1024



Square sRGB master, exported from the design system file. iOS applies the squircle mask; never pre-round the corners.

AT SIZE



180 PX · IPHONE @3X



120 PX · IPHONE @2X



60 PX · SPOTLIGHT

SYSTEM VARIANTS · IOS 18+



DEFAULT



DARK



TINTED

RULES

01 Master is a 1024 × 1024 sRGB PNG: opaque, square, no alpha, no pre-rounded corners.

02 Keep the mark inside the central 66% safe zone; nothing critical near the edges.

03 Ship default, dark, and tinted variants. Tinted is grayscale; the system applies color.

04 Never add text, badges, or borders. The mark and the gradient are the icon.

SECTION 04

Color

Primary Palette

Secondary Palette

Color in Use

Building the Gradients

04

SECTION 04 · COLOR

Primary Palette

DARK MODE · PRIMARY GRADIENT

MAIN · #000000

Dark	Darker	Darkest	Light
#3A2A20	#232726	#2B1B1C	#303429

LIGHT MODE · PRIMARY GRADIENT

MAIN · #F6F2F0

Dark	Darker	Darkest	Light
#EED7E3	#D7C3DD	#BDC1DE	#F1E5E8

Primary surfaces are grainy gradients built from these stops, never flat fills at hero scale. Main is the anchor; shades tune the blend.

SECTION 04 · COLOR

Secondary Palette

DARK MODE · SECONDARY GRADIENT

MAIN · #1D130D

Dark
#402B20

Darker
#342217

Darkest
#26150C

LIGHT MODE · SECONDARY GRADIENT

MAIN · #DCE7EF

Dark
#CBE1ED

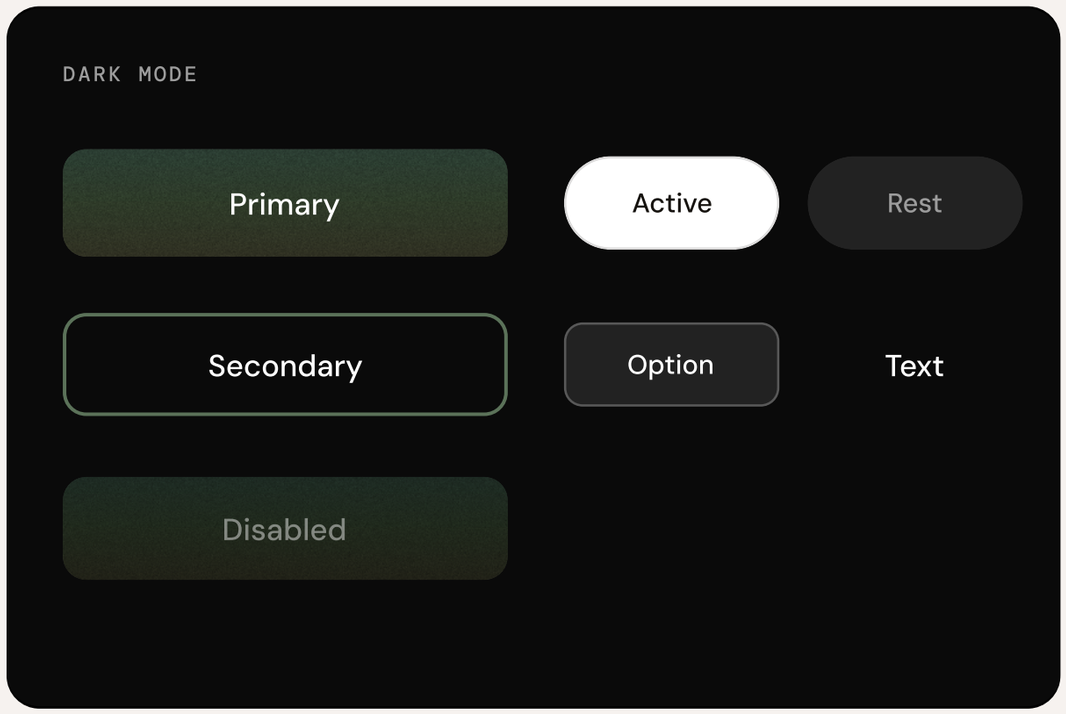
Darker
#C7D9E3

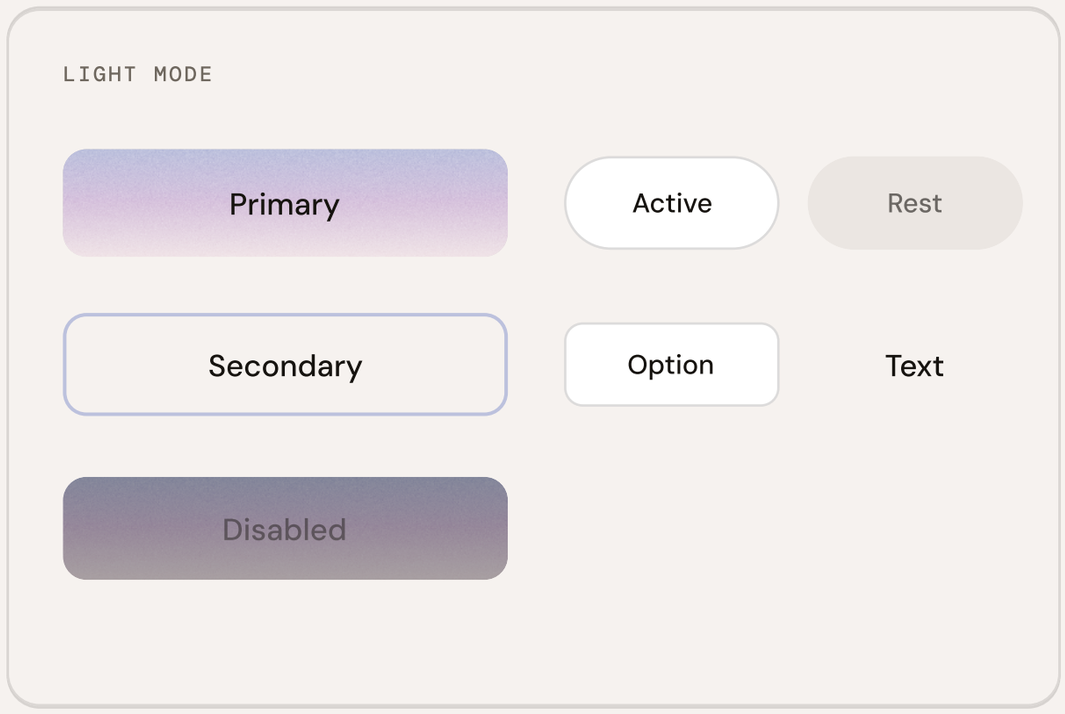
Darkest
#BDD2DD

Secondary gradients carry quieter surfaces: cards, sheets, section accents. Warm brown in dark mode, cool blue in light. Never mix the two families in one composition.

SECTION 04 · COLOR

Color in Use





PAIRING RULES

The primary is always the loudest element on its surface: a soft-grain gradient in its mode's family (the forest #2C3F34 family in dark, the light family in light), borderless. The secondary is an outlined button: transparent fill with a colored outline, sage #5B725A in dark and periwinkle #BDC1DE in light, 1.5px. Lilac #D1C3DB stays in the kit as the light-mode accent: emphasis fills and selected states, never the primary. One gradient primary per screen, reserved for the money moment. Pills are flat: white when active with a hairline ink outline, warm grey #ECE7E2 at rest; supporting pills are small rounded rectangles, radius 8. Tertiary actions are text only. Buttons are radius 10; disabled is the same button under 30% black. Text and interactive elements hold 4.5:1 against their surface, no exceptions.

SECTION 04 · COLOR

Building the Gradients

THE RECIPE

01 Start from the family's Main: #000000 in dark mode, #F6F2F0 in light.

02 Run a linear gradient through the shade stops, top-left to bottom-right: Dark, Darker, Darkest, Light. Exact values live on the palette pages.

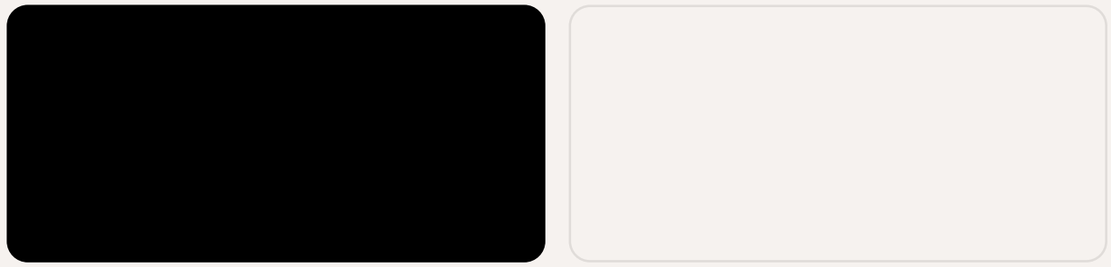
03 Mosaic the blend itself: quantize the gradient into soft horizontal bands. One treatment for every surface and component; never a flat fill, never an untreated gradient on a hero surface.

04 Hero surfaces get the full treatment. Quieter surfaces borrow the secondary families at lower contrast.

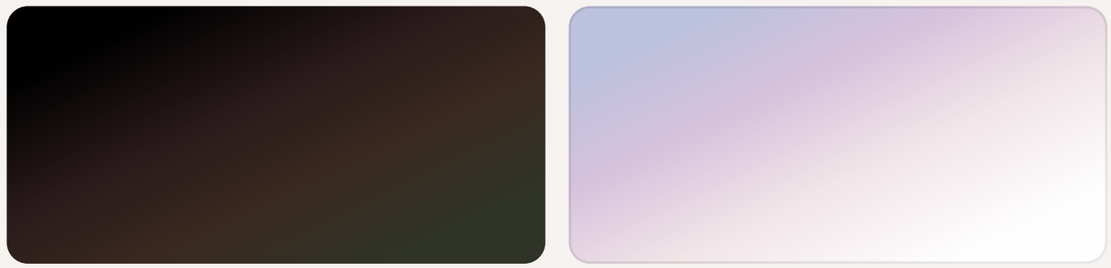
ASSEMBLED · BOTH MODES

DARK LIGHT

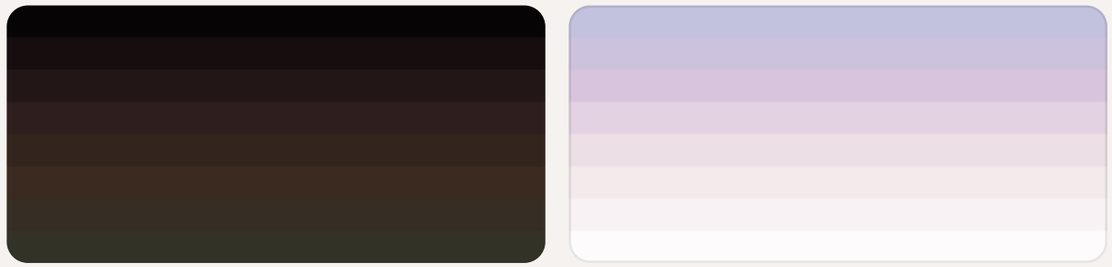
01 · BASE (MAIN)



02 · + LINEAR THROUGH THE STOPS



03 · + MOSAIC (QUANTIZE THE BLEND)



SECTION 05

Typography

Typefaces

The Scale

05

SECTION 05 · TYPOGRAPHY

Typefaces

DM Mono

Light Regular **Medium**

DISPLAY · LABELS · NUMBERS · THE WORDMARK

SECTION 01 · THE BRAND

ZUZU · FAN COMMUNITIES

$1 A MONTH · CANCEL ANYTIME

DM Sans

One weight everywhere: Medium.

BODY · UI

Give independent artists a space they own, where the relationship with fans belongs to the artist and the people who care get to belong too.

HOW THEY PAIR

Mono speaks in caps and numbers; Sans speaks in sentences. Mono is for what the eye scans: labels, prices, section marks, the wordmark. Sans is for what it reads: posts, captions, everything with a full stop.

No Bold, no Italic, no exceptions: weight discipline is part of the look.

SECTION 05 · TYPOGRAPHY

The Scale

SHOWN AT TRUE SIZE · THE 8-14 PX LINER-NOTES RAMP

BIG DISPLAY · DM MONO MEDIUM · 14 PX	Your audience should belong to you.
SCREEN TITLE · DM MONO MEDIUM · 13 PX	Fan Community
SECTION LABEL · DM MONO REGULAR · 12 PX	SECTION 01 · THE BRAND
BODY · DM SANS MEDIUM · 11 PX	Rand just posted a voice memo from the studio.
MICRO LABEL · DM MONO REGULAR · 9 PX	$1 A MONTH · CANCEL ANYTIME
EXTREME MICRO · DM MONO LIGHT · 8 PX	EST. 2026 · FOR ARTISTS & THEIR PEOPLE

CHARACTER SET · DM MONO

AaBbCcDdEeFfGgHhIiJjKkLlMmNnOoPpQqRrSsTtUuVvWwXxYyZz

0123456789 — £$€ ¡!¿?@#&%()[]{}··•

The whole product lives between 8 and 14 px, a printed-artifact scale. Marketing surfaces scale up freely, but keep the mono/sans role split.

SECTION 06

In Practice

Accessibility & Interaction

Do & Don’t

Colophon

06

SECTION 06 · IN PRACTICE

Accessibility & Interaction

CONTRAST	Text and interactive elements hold at least 4.5:1 against their surface, grain included.
TYPE FLOOR	Body copy never drops below 14 px on web surfaces. The 8–13 px microtype is for labels, not paragraphs.
FOCUS & LABELS	Every interactive element has a visible focus state and an aria-label. Imagery ships with alt text.
MOTION	Grain drifts and gradients breathe, but everything respects prefers-reduced-motion and settles within 400 ms.
LOADING	The loading screen is the Z mark above a thin progress bar. Quiet, dark-mode first, no spinners.

SECTION 06 · IN PRACTICE

Do & Don’t

DO

- Put the artist’s name first. ZuZu stays backstage
- Write to one fan, in plain words
- Keep price quiet: “$1 a month · cancel anytime”
- Use grainy gradients for hero moments
- Lead with early access and recognition

DON’T

- Say “inner circle”, “members”, “VIP”, or “subscription”
- Put the price in a headline or CTA
- Flat-fill a hero surface
- Manufacture urgency: “last chance”, “don’t miss out”
- Show member counts on fan-facing pages

ZuZu

BRAND GUIDE · V1.0 · JULY 2026

Typeset in DM Mono & DM Sans. Maintained by the ZuZu team in the ZuZu design system file.

YOUR AUDIENCE SHOULD BELONG TO YOU.